

The Heart of the Noble Ten Vajrapāṇis

Ārya Daśa Vajrapāṇi Hṛdaya · Toh 754 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྣམས་ཀྱི་བཅུ་སྟེང་གི་པོ་

Toh 754 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in English as The Heart of the Noble Ten Vajrapāṇis, corresponding to the Sanskrit Ārya Daśa Vajrapāṇi Hṛdaya and the Tibetan Phags pa rdo rje lag pa bcu pa'i snying po. The text belongs to the class of dhāraṇī scriptures and concerns the protective power of knowing the names, lineages, and secret mantras of ten great yakṣa commanders associated with Vajrapāṇi. Cast as a discourse delivered by the Buddha to his attendant Ānanda at Śrāvastī, it promises that those who possess this knowledge will be shielded from curses, yakṣas, rākṣasas, and other harmful forces. As a dhāraṇī sūtra, it sits within the broader collection of canonical Buddhist scriptures preserved in the Kangyur.

Then that brahmin youth released a Brahmā-like voice and proclaimed these vajra words in all three divine abodes. The dhāraṇī of the subtle vajra, the unobstructed one, is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya Daśa Vajrapāṇi Hṛdaya. In the Tibetan language: The Heart of the Noble Ten Vajrapāṇis.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the park of Prince Jeta.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the Venerable Ānanda:

Ānanda, whatever son or daughter of good family knows the name, the lineage, or the secret mantra of the ten great yakṣa commanders Vajrapāṇi, no curse shall have power over that person. Yakṣas shall not harm them. Rākṣasas, those who devour flesh, and those who consume smoke shall not harm them. Those who cast spells from afar shall likewise not be able to harm them.

Thus it is: ukiri makiri, mīri capāśa pari, ulime, milime, ilime, milime, ilime, milime, ilima lime, hikke, dhikke, hukke, dhu dhure, pradhare, alaṃphale, phālaṃphale, khukhu meti kumetu me, khiri khiri, sādha sādha, sarva kvale, bandha ma kvale.

Ānanda, may these ten great yakṣa commanders Vajrapāṇi always follow behind me, and even when I am asleep, when I am intoxicated, or when I am greatly intoxicated, may they protect, utterly guard, utterly hold, utterly maintain, pacify, and bring me to wellbeing. May they receive the Blessed One's command to do so. They are as follows: Victor Most Excellent of Herds, Wilderness Dweller, Snow Dweller, the Precious Five, Good Jewel, Good Renown, the son of Ugly Body who makes beautiful, Beautiful Garland, and the great Dharma-protecting king, son of Vaiśravaṇa. May these ten great yakṣa commanders Vajrapāṇi always follow behind me, and even when I am overcome by sleep, when I am intoxicated, when I am greatly intoxicated, may they protect, utterly guard, utterly hold, utterly maintain, pacify, and bring me to wellbeing. May they receive the Blessed One's command to do so.

May the foundations of these mantras be accomplished. Svāhā. Thus it is: sara saraṇe svāhā.

As for the foundations of the mantras of those ten Vajrapāṇis, they are these: Thus it is: ugate, kete, saṃkate, uṃḍule, dhadhe, tate, tapattesvāsā, ci ce ci ce, ci khe lo chedani, bhedani, sarva vidyā chedani, sarva gr̥ta, kākḥorda, para kṛta nāśani.

As for the supreme foundations of the mantras of those ten Vajrapāṇis, kings of knowledge-mantras, they are these: Thus it is: ale lakṣe va ke le lakṣe, ake, vake, lakṣe svāhā. Thus it is: hutu hutu, hutu tu, vitu vitu, vitu tu, gaccha gaccha, sapte, pataha taye svāhā. Namo bhagavato buddhyasya siddhyantu mantra mantra parā svāhā.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the Venerable Ānanda, together with the gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas, rejoiced, and they acclaimed what the Blessed One had proclaimed.

The Heart of the Noble Ten Vajrapāṇis is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The list of the ten yakṣa commanders presents genuine difficulty. Several of the names are obscure and some appear to be epithet-translations rather than proper transliterations. "Lnga rtsen" rendered "the Precious Five" is uncertain; it may be a proper name meaning something like "Precious Excellence." "Lus ngan gyi bus mdzed byed" is awkward and has been rendered as literally as possible: "the son of Ugly Body who makes beautiful," which may indicate a specific mythological figure whose Sanskrit name is not recoverable from this passage alone. The mantra syllables throughout are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan without normalization, as their correct Sanskrit forms cannot be established with certainty from this witness alone.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.